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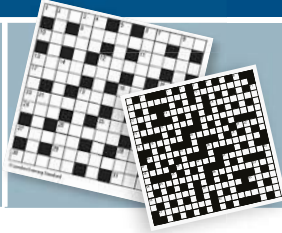
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Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

■ Ramadan decorations at Dubai Festival City. Ramadan is expected to begin from Saturday, March 1, in most Islamic countries, according to astronomers.

Ramadan: Flexible hours, remote work for Dubai Government staff

Private sector encouraged to adopt similar measures

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The Dubai Government Human Resources Department (DGHR) yesterday approved flexible working hours and remote work policy for Dubai government employees during Ramadan 2025.

This is in line with the directives of Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council.

Under the new guidelines, government employees will be allowed flexible working hours, with up to three hours of flexibility. They are required to complete 5.5 hours of work from Monday to Thursday. On Friday, they should work for only three hours. Additionally,

Government employees are required to complete 5.5 hours of work from Monday to Thursday. On Friday, they should work for only three hours.

government employees are permitted to work remotely for up to two days a week, depending on their job requirements, work conditions, and the nature of their responsibilities, DGHR said.

No disruption

The policy mandates that employees should coordinate with their direct managers to ensure smooth operations and maintain productivity, ensuring no disruption to daily tasks in the interest of public service.

The policy also encourages the private sector to adopt similar measures during Ramadan that are tailored to the specific needs of businesses and ensure the seamless con-

tinuity of their operations, said DGHR.

"This policy aligns with the leadership's announcement of 2025 as the 'Year of Community' and reflects Dubai Government's commitment to fostering an optimal work environment while promoting community values," stated DGHR.

This initiative is part of Dubai's ongoing commitment to creating the best possible work environment for government employees, enhancing their comfort, and motivating them to increase productivity, it added.

Working hours have also been reduced by two hours per day during Ramadan for the private sector employees.

However, the Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratization (MoHRE) has clarified that companies may apply flexible work patterns or remote work within the limits of the daily working hours specified during Ramadan depending on the requirements and nature of their work.

SEE ALSO P3

Dh20 to be minimum Nol card top-up at Dubai Metro stations

New amount while recharging at vending machines effective from March 1

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) in Dubai has announced that it will increase the minimum amount to recharge Nol cards at vending machines in Dubai Metro stations from March 1.

"Starting March 1, 2025, the minimum top-up amount for Nol cards via ticket vending machines in Dubai Metro stations will be Dh20," RTA stated on social media.

The previous minimum amount to recharge Nol cards via ticket vending machines in Dubai Metro Stations was Dh5.

"Top-up your balance digi-

tally and save time," RTA said while announcing the new policy for recharging at vending machines. RTA said more details are available on the FAQs page on its website or via its Customer Service Centre available 24/7 at 8009090.

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Trump envoy says developers to meet on Gaza

HAMAS TO EXCHANGE BODIES OF FOUR HOSTAGES FOR 625 PRISONERS

WASHINGTON

Steve Witkoff, US President Donald Trump's special envoy to the Middle East, says a summit will soon be held with real estate developers and planners from the region to discuss the administration's controversial plan for Gaza.

"We're going to conduct a summit pretty soon with probably the biggest developers in the Middle East region, many of the Arab developers — lots of master planners," Witkoff said at an event in Washington on Tuesday night. "I think when people see some of the ideas that come from this, they're going to be amazed."

He said Trump believed it was time for new solutions to the Middle East's most polarising conflict. He added that many countries had contacted the US to be part of "some sort of permanent solution" for residents of war-torn Gaza.

Talks on track

Hamas, meanwhile, said it will hand over the bodies of four Israeli hostages scheduled for yesterday night in what it said would be an exchange for 625 Palestinian prisoners, capping the first phase of a Gaza ceasefire deal.

The United States said talks were on track for a second phase of the ceasefire deal that has largely held but whose complex-

We're going to conduct a summit pretty soon with probably the biggest developers in the Middle East region, many of the Arab developers — lots of master planners."

Steve Witkoff

■ Trump's special envoy to the Middle East

ity and long-drawn-out implementation have highlighted its fragility. Witkoff, who plans to return to the Middle East this week, said that "we're not talking about an eviction" plan for Gazans. But, he said, it was impractical for them to stay over the 10-to-15 years the US government thinks it would take to properly rebuild the coastal enclave.

He described Gaza as a "giant slum" that had been devastated by around 16 months of war, and said a long-term redevelopment plan was needed. "There are many countries, by the way, out there, that from a humanitarian standpoint, we've spoken to many of them, are actually extending themselves and saying, hey, look, we, would love to be a part of some sort of permanent solution for the Gaza people," Witkoff said.

— Bloomberg

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